Topic 2 — East India Company (कंपनी) Expansion

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

East India Company and Nawabs of Bengal | Nawabs of Bengal | Battle of Plassey (प्लासी) | Battle of Buxar (बक्सर) | Bengal Administration | Governors of Bengal | British Expansion Policy | British Colonial States | Colonial India: Annexations, Revolts, Wars and Administrative Reforms | Colonial India: Important Events | Major British Battles | Anglo-Mysore (आंग्ल-मैसूर) Wars (आंग्ल-मैसूर) | Mysore (मैसूर) State | Anglo-Maratha (आंग्ल-मराठा) Wars | Anglo-Sikh (आंग्ल-सिख) Wars | First Anglo-Sikh War | Treaty of Lahore (1846) | Treaty of Amritsar (अमृतसर) (1809) | Anglo-Nepal War | Treaty of Sugauli (1816) | Sikh Empire | Banaras Rebellion | Akbar (अकबर) Fort, Prayagraj (प्रयागराज) | Robert Clive (क्लाइव) | Warren Hastings (वारेन) | Subsidiary Alliance (सहायक संधि) | Doctrine of Lapse (विलुप्ति सिद्धांत) | Anglo-Burmese Wars | Sindh Annexation | Punjab Annexation | Pindari (पिंडारी) Campaign | Vellore Mutiny | Anglo-Afghan Wars | Anglo-Bhutanese Relations | Anglo-Tibetan Relations | Masterly Inactivity (मास्टरी इनएक्टिविटी) | Proud Reserve

> **Sources baked in:** NCERT *Themes in Indian History Part III*, Spectrum *A Brief History of Modern India*, UPPCS Prelims PYQs 2018–2025, Ghatnachakra Indian History (EIC & Nawabs of Bengal; Regional States — Punjab & Mysore) **Weight:** ★★★ — Plassey/Buxar/Diwani, treaty-year matching, Mysore/Maratha/Sikh chronology, Subsidiary vs Lapse, Sugauli **Last verified:** September 2026 — gap audit (CCR wars + Dual Govt / Ring Fence / Kohinoor / Multan / Afghan policy fills) **Current Affairs:** N/A (historical)

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q26

Consider the following wars and arrange them in correct chronological order.

1. First Anglo-Mysore War
2. Second Anglo-French War
3. First Anglo-Sikh War
4. First Anglo-Afghan War

A. 2, 1, 4, 3

B. 1, 2, 3, 4

C. 1, 2, 4, 3

D. 2, 1, 3, 4

Show answer

Ans: A — 2nd Anglo-French (c.1749–54) → 1st Mysore (1767–69) → 1st Afghan (1839–42) → 1st Sikh (1845–46).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q64

Consider the following events and arrange them in chronological order.

I. Battle of Mudki II. Battle of Porto Novo III. Battle of Shakarkheda IV. Battle of Bedara

A. II, III, IV, I

B. III, IV, II, I

C. IV, III, II, I

D. I, II, III, IV

Show answer

Logic: | Battle | Year | Theatre | |--------|------|---------| | Shakarkheda | **1724** | Nizam-ul-Mulk vs Mubariz Khan | | Bedara | **1759** | English vs Dutch (Bengal) | | Porto Novo | **1781** | 2nd Anglo-Mysore | | Mudki | **1845** | 1st Anglo-Sikh | **Ans: B** — III, IV, II, I.

2.0 One clear picture — how the Company became an empire

British rule in India did **not** begin as a planned land empire. It grew in **phases**. Hold this map first; every later card plugs into it.

Phase	Rough years	Method	Key fact
Commercial foothold	to c.1750	Factories under local leave	Surat, Calcutta, Madras
Political breakthrough	**1757–65**	Puppet Nawab → **Diwani**	Plassey → Buxar → Allahabad
Dual / direct Bengal	**1765–72**	Take revenue, dodge blame → then direct charge	Clive creates; Hastings ends Dual Govt
Ring Fence	**1770s–90s**	Buffer states around Bengal	Awadh as shield; **not** Subsidiary Alliance
Non-intervention	Cornwallis (कॉर्नवालिस) / Shore	Avoid costly wars when possible	Brief pause before Wellesley
Subsidiary Alliance	**Wellesley 1798–1805**	Troops + subsidy + Resident	First = **Hyderabad 1798**
Paramountcy	**Lord Hastings** era	Smash rivals; claim overlordship	Nepal, Pindaris, Third Maratha
Annexation drive	**Dalhousie 1848–56**	Lapse + war + “misrule”	Jhansi/Nagpur vs **Awadh 1856** (अवध)

Why the English won (Spectrum facts, keep short):

- Better firearms, drill and paid standing troops.
- Steady war finance from Bengal revenue after **1765**.

- Indian powers were divided; the Company picked allies and paid traitors.
- A second line of commanders (Clive, Coote, Lake, Arthur Wellesley) fought for the Company, not only for one king.

What this topic does *not* dig into: day-to-day Permanent Settlement (स्थायी बंदोबस्त) detail and full Governor-General reform lists live with administration notes. Here the fact is **expansion**.

> **Logic:** Start every answer from the **phase**. Plassey is not Diwani. Subsidiary is not Lapse. Warren Hastings is not Lord Hastings.

Deccan (दक्कन) marker — Battle of Shakarkheda, 1724

Nizam-ul-Mulk (Asaf Jah I) vs **Mubariz Khan** | Berar / Buldhana belt | **11 October 1724**

- After Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब), Deccan politics broke into successor contests. The Mughal court under **Muhammad Shah** tried to check **Nizam-ul-Mulk** (निजाम-उल-मुल्क) by backing **Mubariz Khan** as Deccan subedar.
- At **Shakarkheda (Shakar Kheda (खेड़ा))**, Nizam-ul-Mulk defeated and killed Mubariz Khan.
- Maratha help under **Baji Rao I** is often noted in this fight.
- The victory fixed **Asaf Jahi** power in the Deccan and is treated as the founding moment of independent **Hyderabad** under the Nizams.
- Chronology marker: **Shakarkheda = 1724** — before Bedara, Porto Novo, or Mudki.

> **Logic:** Shakarkheda is **Nizam (निजाम) vs Mughal nominee**, not Anglo-Mysore and not Anglo-Sikh.

2.1 Bengal on the eve — Nawabs and Company friction

Richest Mughal subah | capital **Murshidabad** | Company base **Fort William, Calcutta**

- Bengal's wealth rested on **textiles, saltpetre, indigo (नील) and land revenue**.
- Under Emperor **Farrukhsiyar's farman of 1717**, the Company gained major duty-free trade privileges in Bengal for a fixed annual payment. Later Nawabs fought the private misuse of those **dastaks**.
- Conflict grew when English private traders used **dastaks** (duty-free passes) beyond Company goods.
- The Nawabs wanted customs control. The Company wanted fort rights and trade privilege.
- **Murshid Quli Khan** (मुर्शिद कुली खान) (from **1717**) was the first strong independent-minded Nawab and the **last Subedar of Bengal appointed independently by the Mughal Emperor**. He shifted the capital from Dhaka to **Maksudabad**, renamed **Murshidabad**, and used the **ijara (revenue-farming)** system in land settlement.
- **Shujauddin** followed him. Then came **Sarfaraz Khan**.
- **Alivardi Khan** killed Sarfaraz and ruled **1740–56**.
- Alivardi fought the Maratha **Bargis**. He was the last strong Nawab before the Plassey crisis.

- Comparing Europeans to **honeybees**, Alivardi said that if left undisturbed they give honey, but if disturbed they sting to death.
- Alivardi died in **April 1756**. His young grandson **Siraj-ud-Daulah** succeeded.

Siraj-ud-Daulah and the road to Plassey, 1756–57

Nawab of Bengal | capital **Murshidabad** | short reign **1756–57**

Court and succession (उत्तराधिकार क्रम)

- Siraj inherited a divided court. Powerful rivals included his aunt **Ghaseti Begum**, cousin **Shaukat Jung** of Purnea, the state bankers **Jagat Seth**, merchant **Omichand (Amin Chand)**, and commanders such as **Mir Jafar** and **Rai (राई) Durlabh**.
- Bankers and nobles feared Siraj's temper and feared for their wealth. That distrust later opened the door to Clive's conspiracy.

Three grievances against the English

- The Company misused **dastaks** under the **1717 farman**. Private English traders escaped customs and drained Nawabi revenue.
- The English strengthened **Fort William** at Calcutta without the Nawab's leave, especially after fear of the French in the **Seven Years' War**.
- The Company gave asylum to **Krishnadas**, son of **Raj Ballabh**, who had fled with treasure against Siraj's will. Siraj demanded extradition. Calcutta refused.
- Siraj sent envoys to settle these points. Governor **Roger Drake** insulted the Nawab's messenger and refused to demolish the new works. Open clash followed.

Course — Kasimbazar, Calcutta, Black Hole

- Siraj first took the English factory (फैक्टरी) at **Kasimbazar (Cossimbazar)**.
- He then marched on Calcutta and captured **Fort William on 20 June 1756**.
- He renamed Calcutta **Alinagar** for a short time and left it under his officers.
- After the fall, English prisoners were locked overnight in a small fort dungeon. **J. Z. Holwell** later claimed about **146** were packed into a cell of roughly **18 × 14 feet**, and that about **123** died of heat and suffocation, with only about **23** surviving. That story is the **Black Hole of Calcutta**.
- Numbers are debated by modern writers. Contemporary Muslim historian **Ghulam Hussain** does not mention the episode in **Siyar-ul-Mutakherin**. Holwell's account still became English propaganda for revenge.

English return and Treaty of Alinagar

- News reached Madras. **Robert Clive** and Admiral **Charles Watson** sailed north with a relief force.
- They recaptured Calcutta in **January 1757**.
- Under pressure, Siraj signed the **Treaty of Alinagar on 9 February 1757**.
- The treaty restored English trade privileges under the old farman, returned Calcutta, and allowed the Company to fortify Fort William. The Company recognised Siraj as Nawab and promised peace.
- Trust was already dead. Clive soon opened secret talks with **Mir Jafar**, **Jagat Seth**, **Rai Durlabh**, **Yar Latif Khan** and **Omichand**. That conspiracy decided **Plassey (23 June 1757)**.

Nawab	Years	Tag
Murshid Quli Khan	from **1717**	Last Mughal-appointed Subedar; Murshidabad; ijara
Shujauddin	after Murshid Quli	Bridge ruler before Sarfaraz
Sarfaraz Khan	brief	Killed by Alivardi
Alivardi Khan	**1740–56**	Last strong Nawab; Bargis; honeybee remark
Siraj-ud-Daulah	**1756–57**	Three grievances; Alinagar; Black Hole; fell at Plassey
Mir Jafar	from **1757**	First puppet after Plassey
Mir Qasim	**1760–63**	Munger; equal duties; Buxar ally
Najm-ud-Daulah	after **1765**	Pensioned figurehead under Diwani

> **Logic:** Siraj's three grievances = **dastaks**, **Fort William**, **Krishnadas asylum**. Alinagar is **February 1757**, not Diwani. Black Hole is Holwell's claim, not an undisputed headcount. Independent Nawabi ends at **Plassey** (प्लासी); **Diwani is 1765**.

2.2 Battle of Plassey, 23 June 1757

Palashi (Nadia, Bengal) on the Bhagirathi (भागीरथी) | English **Robert Clive** | Nawab **Siraj-ud-Daulah**

Causes

- The long quarrel of **1756–57** is taught in the Siraj card above: dastak misuse, Fort William works, Krishnadas asylum, capture of Calcutta, Black Hole propaganda, then **Treaty of Alinagar**.
- After Alinagar the English still feared French help to Siraj in the **Seven Years' War**.
- Court enemies of Siraj — **Mir Jafar** (mir bakshi), **Rai Durlabh**, banker **Jagat Seth**, **Yar Latif Khan**, and intermediary **Omichand** — plotted with Clive to replace the Nawab.
- Clive's aim was no longer only restored trade. It was a **puppet Nawab** who would protect Company power in Bengal.

Course of the battle

- Clive's force was small, about **3,000**. Siraj's army (सेना) looked large on paper, about **50,000**.
- Before the fight, Clive sealed a secret deal: **Mir Jafar** would be made Nawab if he held back his troops.
- **Omichand** was deceived by Clive's forged or dual treaty.
- On **23 June 1757** the armies met at Plassey. Fighting lasted only hours on one afternoon.
- Rain soaked Siraj's gunpowder. That helped the English, but **conspiracy** was the real reason for defeat.
- Mir Jafar and Rai Durlabh did not press their wings. Siraj's line collapsed.
- Siraj fled, was captured, and was later killed on orders linked to Mir Jafar's side (**Miran**).

Results

- **Mir Jafar** became the first **puppet Nawab** of Bengal.
- The Company received the **zamindari of the 24 Parganas** and huge presents.
- Plassey founded a **political empire** through a puppet. It did **not** give the **Diwani**.
- English military supremacy in Bengal was fixed. The road to northern politics opened.
- Independent Nawabi power effectively ended.

> **Logic:** Plassey = **1757**, **Clive**, **Mir Jafar**. Diwani = **1765** after Buxar.

2.3 From Mir Qasim to Buxar and the Treaty of Allahabad

Mir Qasim and the break with the Company (background to Buxar)

- Mir Jafar could not satisfy endless Company demands. In **1760** the Company replaced him with son-in-law **Mir Qasim**.
- Under the **1760 arrangement**, Mir Qasim cleared dues, promised war help in the south, and accepted friendship with the Company. Mir Jafar was pensioned.
- Mir Qasim shifted the capital to **Munger (Monghyr)** to keep distance from Calcutta.
- He reformed the army on European lines and set up arms works at Munger for **matchlock** manufacture.
- He tried to abolish internal duties so that **Indian and English traders paid equally**.
- Officers involved in embezzlement were fined heavily; new taxes helped repair Bengal's finances.
- Private English misuse of **dastaks** made equal duties a clash of principles. Open war followed in **1763**.
- After the **Patna (पटना) massacre of 1763**, the English reinstalled **Mir Jafar**. Mir Qasim fled west and joined Awadh and the Emperor.

Battle of Buxar, 22 October 1764

Buxar (Bihar) | English commander **Major Hector Munro** | Clive was in England

Causes

- Mir Qasim's equal-duty policy and war with the Company in **1763** left him without Bengal.
- He sought help from **Shuja-ud-Daula** (शुजाउद्दौला) of **Awadh** (अवध) and the Mughal Emperor **Shah Alam II**.
- The three formed a **triple alliance** to break English power in northern India.
- For the Company, this was no longer a Bengal palace fight. It was a contest for supremacy over the Gangetic plains.

Course of the war / battle

- After Patna and the 1763 fighting, Mir Qasim's own force was weakened. The real strength of the coalition (गठबंधन) was Awadh and imperial troops.

- The armies met at **Buxar on 22 October 1764**.
- Munro's disciplined Company sepoys and artillery faced a much larger Indian coalition.
- The fight was a **real pitched battle**, not a Plassey-style conspiracy.
- Coalition coordination broke under Munro's attack. Mir Qasim's contingent failed to hold.
- **Henry Vansittart** was Governor of Bengal at the time of Buxar; **Mir Jafar** was again Nawab of Bengal on the Company side of the political ledger.
- Shuja-ud-Daula's army was driven back. Shah Alam II's position collapsed with the field.
- The triple alliance was **routed**. Mir Qasim fled again. Shuja retreated toward Awadh. Shah Alam sought terms with the English.

Results

- Buxar made the Company the **strongest power in northern India**, not only in Bengal.
- Unlike Plassey, this was a clear military verdict against three major Indian powers together.
- Restored Mir Jafar (and then his successor) had to hand **Midnapore, Burdwan and Chittagong** revenues toward Company army costs. That was still short of full Diwani.
- Political settlement waited for Clive's return in **1765**. The legal stamp of victory was the **Treaty of Allahabad** (इलाहाबाद की संधि).
- Revenue of Bengal–Bihar–Orissa after Diwani financed later Company wars across India.

Treaty of Allahabad, August 1765 (settlement of Buxar)

Clive returned in **1765** and settled two linked treaties at Allahabad / the Prayagraj belt.

Party	Terms
Shah Alam II	Granted **Diwani** of Bengal, Bihar, Orissa; about **₹26 lakh/year**; lived under Company protection at Allahabad
Shuja-ud-Daula	Kept Awadh after large indemnity (about **₹50 lakh**); **Allahabad and Kora (Kara)** went to the Emperor under English control; Banaras zamindar (ज़मींदार) **Balwant Singh** secured
Bengal Nawab	**Najm-ud-Daulah** became a pensioned figurehead

- **Diwani** = right to collect **land revenue**.
- Spectrum also notes a large Company claim linked to **nizamat** functions (defence, police, justice) alongside the Diwani farman. In practice Dual Government blurred both.
- Political empire now had a **legal Mughal stamp**.

> **Logic:** Munro fought; Clive settled. Allahabad = **1765**. Buxar is **not** a Bengal-only battle.

2.4 Bengal administration after Diwani

- **Diwani (1765)** meant the Company collected revenue of **Bengal, Bihar and Orissa**.

- **Nizamat** (police and criminal justice) stayed in the Nawab's **name**.
- In practice the Company also controlled Nizamat by nominating the deputy and keeping the army.
- **Dual Government (1765–72)** was Clive's design: take the profit, avoid the blame for day-to-day rule.
- Under Dual Government the Company held **real power** (army + revenue) while the Nawab kept the **show of sovereignty**.
- The Nawab received a fixed **nizamat allowance**; the Company took the surplus of the Diwani.
- The Company appointed two deputy Diwans: **Muhammad Reza Khan** for Bengal (Murshidabad) and **Raja Shitab Rai** for Bihar. Indians ran collection under Company authority.
- Company servants and their agents drained Bengal through private trade and forced purchases. Responsibility for famine and disorder stayed on the Nawab's empty title.
- **K. M. Panikkar** later called Bengal under Dual Government a **"state of dacoits"** for the Company's plunder phase (**1765–72**).
- After Diwani, English contact with the **Khasi** (खासी) hills grew from the Sylhet side. Later road plans under **David Scott** met tough resistance under **Tirot Sing**.
- Administration collapsed. The **Bengal Famine of 1770** is the catastrophe of this dual system.
- In **1772 Warren Hastings** ended Dual Government. The Company took **direct** civil and revenue charge.
- Hastings shifted the seat of revenue management toward **Calcutta**, dismissed the dual fiction, and brought Reza Khan / Shitab Rai under Company trial and control.
- **Clive** governed Bengal **1758–60** and again **1765–67** (Diwani and Dual Government). During his terms Company plunder of Bengal resources deepened, and a **White Mutiny** among English officers also belongs to his governorship phase.
- **Verelst** and **Cartier** governed while Dual Government continued, including the famine years.
- **Hastings (1772–85)** ended Dual Government, used Ring Fence, faced Banaras **1781**, and fought the First Maratha War.
- **Cornwallis (1786–93)** later brought the **Permanent Settlement of Bengal** (administration detail lives with revenue notes).

> **Logic:** Clive **created** Dual Government; Hastings **ended** it in **1772**, not in 1857. Deputy Diwans = **Reza Khan (Bengal)** and **Shitab Rai (Bihar)**.

2.5 Robert Clive

Company writer at Madras from 1743 | defence of **Arcot 1751** | **Plassey 1757** (प्लासी) | Diwani settlement **1765**

- He rose in the Carnatic struggle and became the architect of English power in Bengal.
- He designed the **Mir Jafar** conspiracy that won Plassey.
- He is widely called the **founder of the British Empire in India**. William Pitt called him a **"Heaven-Born General."**
- In his second Bengal term he negotiated the **Treaty of Allahabad, 1765**, and set up Dual Government.

- He did **not** command at Buxar.
- Parliament later inquired into his presents and jagir (जागीर).
- He died in **1774**.

> **Logic:** Clive = Plassey + Diwani frame + "Heaven-Born General". Hastings = end of Dual Government + Ring Fence + Banaras + Salbai.

2.6 Warren Hastings (expansion only)

Governor of Bengal from 1772 | first **Governor-General of Bengal from 1773** (Regulating Act)

- In **1772** he ended Dual Government. The Company took direct revenue and civil charge.
- His **Ring Fence** policy used friendly or dependent neighbours as an informal **buffer ring** around Bengal.
- **Awadh** was the main shield on the western side. The Company propped the Nawab so that Maratha or Afghan pressure would hit Awadh first, not Bengal.
- Ring Fence was **defensive diplomacy**, not a formal treaty system of British troops + subsidy + Resident.
- Do not call Ring Fence the **Subsidiary Alliance**. That ladder step belongs to **Wellesley from 1798**.
- He fought the **Rohilla War in 1774** with Shuja-ud-Daula against the Rohillas of Rohilkhand.
- The **First Anglo-Maratha War** ended with the **Treaty of Salbai, 1782**.
- The **Banaras Rebellion of 1781** was his clash with Raja **Chait Singh** of Banaras (present-day Varanasi (वाराणसी)).
- Hastings demanded war subsidy and cavalry, tried to arrest Chait Singh at **Shivala**, then fled to **Chunar** (चुनार). **Major Popham** helped crush the rising. Chait Singh was deposed. The case later fed Hastings's impeachment.
- The **Asiatic Society of Bengal** was founded in **1784** by **Sir William Jones**.
- Hastings **declined** the presidentship in Jones's favour.
- He was impeached in Britain from **1788 to 1795** over Chait Singh, the Rohillas and presents. He was **acquitted**.

> **Logic:** Keep this card for expansion facts — Dual Government **1772**, Ring Fence, Salbai, Banaras. Full office/reform lists sit with Governor-General notes.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q22

Assertion (A): The Asiatic Society of Bengal was established in the period of Warren Hastings and he modestly declined the offer of Presidentship of that learned body in favour of Sir William Jones.

Reason (R): Warren Hastings was himself a great scholar and an ardent orientalist (प्राच्यवादी) who used to encourage the study of Sanskrit, Persian (फ़ारसी) and Arabic.

Options: A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A) B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Show answer

Ans: B — Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is **not** the correct explanation of (A). Hastings declined the presidentship out of modesty/deference to Jones's scholarship — his own being a scholar is a parallel fact, not the causal reason for declining.

2.7 British expansion policy — full ladder

There was **not** one policy from start to finish. Name the **Governor-General** and the **tool**.

Policy	Who	What it meant	example
Commercial leave	Early Company	Factories under farman / local grant	Surat, Calcutta
Puppet + Diwani	Clive	Install Nawab; then take revenue	Mir Jafar; Allahabad 1765
Ring Fence	Warren Hastings	Buffer allies around Bengal	Awadh as shield
Non-intervention	Cornwallis / John Shore	Avoid expensive forward wars when possible	Pause before Wellesley
Subsidiary Alliance	**Wellesley (1798–1805)**	British force + subsidy/cession + Resident; ruler keeps internal admin	**Hyderabad 1798** first
Paramountcy	**Lord Hastings**	Company as overlord; crush remaining rivals	Nepal; Pindaris; Third Maratha
Doctrine of Lapse	**Dalhousie from 1848**	No natural heir → annex	Satara, Jhansi, Nagpur
Misrule annexation	Dalhousie	Annex for “bad government”	**Awadh 1856** (not Lapse)
Masterly Inactivity	John Lawrence	Caution on Afghanistan after First Afghan War	Watch frontier; avoid occupation
Proud Reserve / Forward Policy	Lytton	Assertive Afghan line in the 1870s	Second Afghan War context

Cornwallis–Shore pause vs Wellesley expansion

- **Cornwallis** and **John Shore** preferred **non-intervention** when costly forward wars could be avoided.
- Cornwallis still fought when Company allies were hit — the **Third Anglo-Mysore War** is his expansion war, not Shore’s quiet phase.
- **Wellesley (1798–1805)** reversed the pause with open **Subsidiary Alliance** diplomacy and war.
- Wellesley’s tools were British troops, subsidy or land cession, and a controlling **Resident**.

- Cornwallis–Shore = hold and settle when possible. Wellesley = bind courts and smash rivals who refuse.
- Wellesley fought the **Fourth Mysore War** and the **Second Maratha War**. He was recalled in **1805** because the wars cost too much.
- **Lord Hastings** (not Warren Hastings) fought Nepal, the Pindaris and the Third Maratha War.
- **Ellenborough** annexed **Sindh in 1843** with field command under **Sir Charles Napier**.
- **Hardinge** fought the First Sikh War.
- **Dalhousie** annexed **Punjab in 1849** and **Awadh in 1856**.
- The **Vellore Mutiny (1806)** sits between Wellesley's recall and the Nepal war on chronology charts.

> **Logic:** Wellesley did **not** invent Lapse. Dalhousie–Lapse is a standing match.

2.8 Subsidiary Alliance

Lord Wellesley (वेलेज़ली) (1798–1805) | perfected from earlier French practice (Dupleix (डुप्ले)'s idea, British system)

- The Indian ruler kept **internal administration**.
- He lost the right to war and peace and could not host other Europeans without British leave.
- He paid a **subsidy** or **ceded land** instead, and accepted a **British Resident**.
- The Company posted a subsidiary force "for his protection." In practice the Resident ran foreign policy.

State	Year
Hyderabad (Nizam)	**1798 — first**
Mysore (Wodeyar)	**1799** after Tipu
Tanjore (Thanjavur (तंजावुर))	**1799** (Wellesley period)
Awadh	**1801** (ceded Rohilkhand / Doab (दोआब) tracts)
Peshwa (पेशवा)	**1802 Treaty of Bassein**
Sindhia / Bhonsle	after Second Maratha War
Many Rajput (राजपूत) states	under Lord Hastings after 1818

- The alliance looked cheaper than annexation at first.
- Wellesley also pressed hard on south Indian courts. **Tanjore** entered subsidiary terms, and the **Carnatic** (कर्नाटक) Nawabi was effectively reduced under Company control in the same forward phase.
- The subsidy later ruined treasuries. **Awadh's path to 1856** is the classic example.
- **Wellesley was recalled in 1805** because expansion wars were too expensive.

> **Logic:** First subsidiary = **Hyderabad 1798**, not Jhansi. Hyderabad was **never** annexed by Lapse.

2.9 Doctrine of Lapse and Awadh 1856

- **Dalhousie** used Lapse from **1848**.
- If a dependent state had **no natural heir**, an adopted (अंगीकृत) son was **not recognised**.
- The state then **lapsed** to the Company.

State	Year	Note
Satara	**1848**	First major Lapse case
Jaitpur, Sambalpur	1849	Smaller Lapse annexations
Baghat	1850	Hill state; annexed then later restored in the Lapse story
Jhansi (झांसी)	**1853**	Gangadhar Rao died; **Damodar (दामोदर) Rao** (Lakshmibai (लक्ष्मीबाई)'s adopted son) **rejected**
Nagpur	**1854**	Major Lapse annexation
Awadh	**1856**	**Wajid Ali Shah** (वाजिद अली शाह); **misgovernance**, **not** Lapse

- Some lists also name **Udaipur** among threatened Lapse cases. Focus stays on **Satara, Jhansi, Nagpur**, and the **Awadh ≠ Lapse** trap.
- Awadh had already been hollowed by the **1801** subsidiary cessions of Rohilkhand / Doab tracts.
- Company Residents and British troops sat deep inside Awadh politics long before **1856**.
- Dalhousie's public charge was **misrule** — weak justice, revenue disorder, and failure to reform under Resident pressure.
- In **1856** Resident **Outram**'s reports and Dalhousie's "misrule" charge led to annexation. **Wajid Ali Shah** was deposed and sent toward Calcutta.
- Awadh was **not** annexed for want of a natural heir. That trap belongs to **Jhansi** and other Lapse cases.
- Lapse and "misrule" together fed the anger that later exploded in **1857**, but this card stops at annexation.

> **Logic:** Dalhousie did **not** recognise Lakshmibai's heir. Awadh **1856** ≠ Lapse.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q40

Match List-I with List-II:

List-I A. Lord Dalhousie B. Lord Curzon (कर्ज़न) C. Lord William Bentinck D. Lord Cornwallis **List-II** 1. Permanent Settlement of Bengal 2. Prohibition (प्रतिषेध) of Practice of Sati 3. Partition of Bengal 4. Doctrine of Lapse

A. 4 3 1 2

B. 3 4 2 1

C. 3 4 1 2

D. 4 3 2 1

Show answer

Ans: D — Dalhousie–Lapse (4), Curzon–Partition (3), Bentinck–Sati (2), Cornwallis–Permanent Settlement (1).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q148

Consider the following statements:

1. Kunwar Singh (कुंवर सिंह), Landlord of Jagdishpur in Bihar, led the rebellion against the British.
2. Lord Dalhousie recognised the adopted son of Rani Lakshmi Bai as the heir apparent.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

A. Only 2

B. Neither 1 nor 2

C. Only 1

D. Both 1 and 2

Show answer

Ans: C — Stmt 1 true (1857). Stmt 2 false: adopted heir **rejected**; Jhansi lapsed **1853**.

2.10 Anglo-Mysore Wars and Mysore State

- After Vijayanagara (विजयनगर)'s fall at **Talikota (1565)**, a **Wodeyar** kingdom rose in Mysore (from early 17th century).
- **Hyder Ali** (हैदर अली) seized real power in **1761**. He had already set up a modern armoury at **Dindigal in 1755**.
- **Tipu Sultan** (टीपू सुल्तान) succeeded in **1782**. He used rockets, kept French contacts, and was called the Tiger of Mysore.
- Tipu also pushed state reforms in trade, sericulture and a new calendar. Papers still test wars and treaties first.
- The capital was **Seringapatam (Srirangapatna (श्रीरंगपट्टनम))**.
- **Haidar Ali** built a modern armoury / sepoy post at **Dindigul in 1755** before he became full ruler of Mysore.
- At Seringapatam Tipu founded a **Jacobin Club**, became its member, and planted a **Tree of Liberty** as a sign of friendship with France.

- Tipu also gave money for the construction of the idol of Goddess **Sharada** at the **Shringeri** temple — a standard "correct statement" fact about him.
- Tipu also set up embassies on modern lines in foreign states such as **Iran, Istanbul, Afghanistan and France** to seek help against the English.
- There were **four** (चातुर्याम) Anglo-Mysore Wars. Fear of French help to Tipu shaped Wellesley's urgency in the Fourth War.

Anglo-Mysore war ladder

War	Years	End / result tag
First	**1767–69**	**Treaty of Madras 1769** (मद्रास) — Hyder strong
Second	**1780–84**	**Pollilur 1780**; **Porto Novo 1781**; **Treaty of Mangalore 1784** (मैंगलोर)
Third	**1790–92**	**Treaty of Seringapatam 1792** — Tipu cedes about half
Fourth	**1799**	Tipu killed **4 May 1799**; Wodeyar child under Subsidiary Alliance

First Anglo-Mysore War, 1767–69

Causes

- Hyder Ali's rise in Mysore alarmed the English, the Nizam and the Marathas.
- Shifting Carnatic alliances opened a four-sided contest for south Indian power.

Course

- Hyder fought the English in the Carnatic and even threatened **Madras**.
- Early English hopes of a quick win failed. Hyder's mobility kept the war open.

Results

- The **Treaty of Madras, 1769** restored a rough status quo with mutual restitution of conquests.
- Hyder secured a defensive understanding that the English later failed to honour fully. That breach fed the Second War.

Second Anglo-Mysore War, 1780–84

Causes

- The English failed Hyder on promised help against the Marathas.
- Hyder also feared English capture of French **Mahe**.
- He allied with the Marathas and the Nizam against the Company.

Course

- Hyder and Tipu swept into the Carnatic.
- At **Pollilur (1780)** they crushed an English force under Baillie.
- **Eyre Coote** reversed the tide at **Porto Novo (1781)**.
- Hyder died in **1782**. Tipu continued the war until settlement.

Results

- The **Treaty of Mangalore, 1784** restored prisoners and largely returned conquered places.
- Tipu remained strong. There was still **no** English subsidiary on Mysore.

Third Anglo-Mysore War, 1790–92

Causes

- Tipu attacked **Travancore**, an English ally.
- **Cornwallis** built a triple front with the Marathas and the Nizam.

Course

- Cornwallis personally led the campaign.
- The allies pressed Tipu back to **Seringapatam**. Tipu faced siege and ruin.

Results

- The **Treaty of Seringapatam, 1792** made Tipu cede about **half** his territory and pay about **₹3 crore**.
- Two of Tipu's sons were taken as hostages.
- The English, Marathas and Nizam shared the ceded lands.

Fourth Anglo-Mysore War, 1799

Causes

- **Wellesley** feared Tipu's French contacts in the Napoleonic age.
- Tipu refused subsidiary subordination to the Company.

Course

- English columns under Harris and Stuart, with the Nizam's help, closed on Seringapatam.
- The fort fell on **4 May 1799**. Tipu was killed fighting.

Results

- Tipu's dynasty ended. About half of Mysore was annexed or shared.
- The rest was restored to the child **Krishna (कृष्ण) Raja Wodeyar III** under **Subsidiary Alliance**.
- Kanara, Coimbatore, Wynad and the Seringapatam belt went to the English; the Nizam got Gooty and related tracts.

> **Logic:** Madras ≠ Mangalore. Tipu did **not** survive 1799. First Mysore comes after the Second Anglo-French War and long before the First Sikh War.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q28

Who among the following established a modem armoury in Dindigal Mysore in 1755?

A. Nanjraj

B. Haider Ali

C. Devraj

D. Chikka Krishnaraj

Show answer

Ans: B — Hyder/Haider Ali. Seringapatam is the capital trap, not the armoury site.

2.11 Anglo-Maratha Wars

- The Maratha confederacy had five main houses.
- The **Peshwa** sat at **Poona**.
- **Sindhia** sat at **Gwalior**.
- **Holkar** sat at **Indore**.
- **Bhonsle** sat at **Nagpur**.
- The **Gaekwad** sat at **Baroda**.
- **Chauth** was the Maratha claim of **one-fourth** of land revenue for "protection". It is **not** the Subsidiary Alliance.
- **Sardeshmukhi** was an extra levy of about **10 percent**.
- After **Panipat 1761**, Madhav Rao I (माधवराव) revived Maratha power, but later houses drifted apart. Division helped the Company.

Peshwa order (raata this table)

Peshwa	Approx.
Balaji Vishwanath (बालाजी विश्वनाथ)	1713–20 (first hereditary Peshwa)
Baji Rao I	1720–40
Balaji Baji Rao (Nana Saheb)	1740–61 (Panipat 1761)
Madhav Rao I	1761–72
Narayan Rao (नारायणराव)	1772–73 (murdered)
Raghunath Rao (Raghoba)	disputed 1773–74
Madhav Rao Narayan (II)	infant; Nana Fadnavis era (Nana d. **1800**)
Baji Rao II	1796–1818 (Bassein; pensioned at **Bithoor**)

Anglo-Maratha war ladder

War	Years	End / result tag
First	**1775–82**	**Treaty of Salbai 1782** — English keep Salsette
Second	**1803–05**	**Bassein 1802** (बसीन) opens war; Assaye / Laswari; Deogaon & Surji-Anjangaon
Third	**1817–18**	**Kirkee 1817**; Peshwa power ends; Pindari hunt

First Anglo-Maratha War, 1775–82

Causes

- After Narayan Rao's murder, **Raghunath Rao (Raghoba)** sought Bombay's help.
- Bombay signed the **Treaty of Surat, 1775**, promising Raghoba the Peshwaship for cessions including Salsette and Bassein claims.
- Calcutta distrusted the deal and tried to revise it by the **Treaty of Purandhar, 1776**.

Course

- Fighting swung for years. The English suffered a famous reverse at **Wadgaon, 1779**.
- Nana Fadnavis and **Mahadaji Sindhia** held the confederacy's centre.
- Warren Hastings pushed a final settlement.

Results

- The **Treaty of Salbai, 1782** restored a status quo peace. The English kept **Salsette**.
- Raghoba was dropped. Madhav Rao Narayan was recognised.
- There was **no Subsidiary Alliance yet**. About twenty years of relative (सापेक्ष) peace followed.

Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803–05

Causes

- Holkar crushed Baji Rao II at Poona.
- The Peshwa fled to the English and signed the **Treaty of Bassein, 31 December 1802** (subsidiary).
- Sindhia and Bhonsle refused to accept a subsidiary Peshwa as overlord.

Course

- Arthur Wellesley won at **Assaye (1803)** and Argaon.
- Lord Lake took Delhi and won at **Laswari**.
- Bhonsle made peace by the **Treaty of Deogaon**. Sindhia by the **Treaty of Surji-Anjangaon**.
- Holkar fought on, then settled by the **Treaty of Rajpurghat, 1805**.

Results

- Maratha houses lost key territories and accepted British paramount pressure.
- Wellesley's wars were costly. He was **recalled in 1805**.
- The confederacy survived in form but not in independence.

Third Anglo-Maratha War, 1817–18

Causes

- Lord Hastings moved against the **Pindaris**.
- Maratha houses feared encirclement.
- Baji Rao II attacked the Poona residency.

Course

- The English won at **Kirkee (1817)** and related actions.
- Pindari bands were hunted down in the same campaign season.
- The Peshwa's power collapsed.

Results

- The **Peshwaship was abolished**.
- Baji Rao II was pensioned at **Bithoor**.
- Large Peshwa territories passed into the **Bombay Presidency (प्रेसीडेंसी)** frame.
- Maratha houses became dependent princes under British paramountcy.
- Central India passed under Company overlordship.

Why the Marathas lost (short):

- The confederacy was divided. Houses fought each other as often as they fought the Company.
- Superior Company artillery, drill and Bengal war finance after Diwani.
- After Bassein the Peshwa himself became a British client, splitting Maratha politics from inside.

> **Logic:** Surat → Purandhar → Salbai for the First War. **Bassein** opens the Second. Start every Peshwa chronology with **Balaji Vishwanath**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q149

Arrange the following in chronological order of their rule:

1. Bajirao (बाजीराव) I (बाजीराव I)
2. Balaji Bajirao (बालाजी बाजीराव)
3. Balaji Vishwanath
4. Madhav Rao I

A. 1, 3, 2, 4

B. 3, 1, 4, 2

C. 3, 1, 2, 4

D. 1, 3, 4, 2

Show answer

Ans: C — Balaji Vishwanath → Bajirao I → Balaji Bajirao → Madhav Rao I.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q1

Consider the following Peshwas and arrange them in ascending chronological order:

1. Raghunath Rao (Raghoba)
2. Balaji Baji Rao
3. Narayan Rao

4. Balaji Vishwanath

A. 4, 2, 3, 1

B. 3, 4, 1, 2

C. 1, 2, 3, 4

D. 1, 3, 2, 4

Show answer

Ans: A — Balaji Vishwanath → Balaji Baji Rao → Narayan Rao → Raghoba (this list skips Baji Rao I and Madhav Rao I).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q35

Consider the reign of the following Peshwas and arrange them in chronological order—

(I) Balaji Vishwanath (II) Bajirao I (III) Narayan Rao (IV) Madhav Rao I

A. I, III, II, IV

B. I, II, III, IV

C. II, I, IV, III

D. I, II, IV, III

Show answer

Ans: D — Vishwanath → Bajirao I → Madhav Rao I → Narayan Rao. **B** wrongly puts Narayan before Madhav Rao I.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q93

The Maratha claim of revenue for protection is known by what name?

A. Sardesh Mukhi

B. Chauth

C. Abwab (अबवाब)

D. Jamadani

Show answer

Ans: B — Chauth. Sardeshmukhi is the extra levy, not the ¼ protection claim.

2.12 Sikh Empire, Anglo-Sikh Wars, Treaty of Lahore, Punjab Annexation

- **Ranjit Singh** (रणजीत सिंह) belonged to the **Sukerchakia** misl. He was born on **13 November 1780**. He unified the Sikh misls and died in **1839**.

- His capital was **Lahore** (taken **1799** after Zaman Shah's goodwill over returned cannon). **Amritsar** (अमृतसर) (taken **1802**) was the religious capital.
- He annexed **Multan (1818)**, **Kashmir (1819)** and **Peshawar / Khyber belt (1834)**.
- **Kohinoor path: Nadir Shah** (नादिर शाह) took it from Delhi (**1739**) → **Ahmad Shah Abdali** → **Shah Shuja** → gifted to **Ranjit Singh** → after Punjab's fall (**1849**) it passed to the British crown under **Dalhousie** / Queen Victoria's court.
- He said God wanted him to look on all religions with one eye, so the light of the other eye was taken — a famous line on his religious tolerance.
- He set up modern foundries to manufacture cannons at **Lahore** (and Amritsar).
- European officers such as **Ventura** and **Allard** trained his army.
- He set up the **Adalat-i-Ala**, the supreme court, at **Lahore**, not Amritsar.
- The empire stretched from the **Khyber** to the **Sutlej** (सतलुज).
- By the **Treaty of Amritsar (25 April 1809)** with the Company (Metcalfe (मेटकाफ़) for **Lord Minto**), Ranjit accepted the **Sutlej** as the southern limit of his push. That kept peace while he lived.
- After **1839** succession chaos (**Kharak / Khadag Singh**, Nau Nihal Singh, Sher Singh and court factions of Dogra vs Sandhanwalia groups) opened the door to war. The Khalsa (खालसा) army remained powerful but politics collapsed.
- **Duleep Singh** was the last Sikh ruler (**1843–49**). He later accepted Christianity, visited Russia, and died in **Paris (1893)**; his funeral was in England.

Sikh empire / Anglo-Sikh timeline

Year	Event
1780	Ranjit born; **Sukerchakia** misl
1799	Takes **Lahore**; makes it capital
1802	Takes **Amritsar**
25 Apr 1809	**Treaty of Amritsar** with Company (**Lord Minto** / Metcalfe) — Sutlej limit
1818	Annexes **Multan**
1819	Annexes **Kashmir**
1834	Annexes **Peshawar** belt
1839	Ranjit dies; succession chaos begins
1845–46	**First Anglo-Sikh War** → **Treaty of Lahore 1846 (लाहौर)**
13 Jan 1849	**Chillianwala** (setback / indecisive)
21 Feb 1849	**Gujrat** — English win
29 Mar 1849	Punjab annexed; **Board of Three**

First Anglo-Sikh War, 1845–46

Causes

- After Ranjit's death the Lahore court was unstable.
- The Khalsa army crossed the Sutlej. **Hardinge** treated this as war.

Course

- Battles followed in quick order — **Mudki (18 Dec 1845)**, Ferozeshah, Aliwal, and the decisive **Sobraon**.
- British losses were heavy, but the Khalsa was forced back.

Results

- The **Treaty of Lahore, 1846** ceded the Jullundur Doab, fixed an indemnity, and placed a resident at Lahore.
- Kashmir was sold to **Gulab Singh** for **₹75 lakh**.
- The **Treaty of Bhairowal, 1846** tightened control over minor **Duleep Singh**.
- Punjab was **not** annexed yet.

Second Anglo-Sikh War, 1848–49

Causes

- In **1848** Diwan **Mulraj** of **Multan** rose against British-backed Lahore authority after a clash that killed two British officers.
- The Multan revolt spread into a wider Sikh rising across the plains.
- **Dalhousie** treated the crisis as a chance for full annexation politics, not another Lahore residency patch.

Course

- British columns first pressed the **siege of Multan**. Mulraj's fort fell after hard fighting late in **1848**.
- Open-field fighting then included Ramnagar and a British setback at **Chillianwala (13 Jan 1849)** — Lord Gough vs Sher Singh; undecided field.
- The decisive victory came at **Gujrat (21 Feb 1849)**.

Results

- Punjab was annexed on **29 March 1849**.
- **Duleep Singh** was deposed and sent to England on a pension of about **₹4–5 lakh** a year (the figure **₹2,50,000** in some stems is the false option).
- The **Kohinoor** passed from the Lahore treasury into British hands with the settlement.
- Punjab became a **Chief Commissionership** under the **Board of Three**.

Board of Three (1849)	Role
Sir Henry Lawrence	President
John Lawrence	Member

Board of Three (1849)	Role
Charles Grenville Mansel	Member

Not on that board: H. M. Elliot and **Robert Montgomery**.

> **Logic: 1809 Amritsar ≠ 1846 Lahore ≠ 1849 annexation**. Mudki = First Sikh, not Mysore. Sukerchakia = Ranjit's misl. Kohinoor path = **Shah Shuja → Ranjit → British (1849)**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q67

At which place did Raja Ranjit Singh set up the Adalat-i-Ala?

A. Amritsar

B. Lahore

C. Firozpur

D. Multan

Show answer

Ans: B — Lahore. Amritsar is the Golden Temple (स्वर्ण मंदिर) trap.

2.13 Anglo-Nepal War and Treaty of Sugauli, 1816

Governor-General: Lord Hastings (not Warren Hastings)

Causes

- The Gurkhas expanded into **Garhwal, Kumaon and Sikkim**.
- Border clashes with Company territories and hill claims made war inevitable.
- Lord Hastings wanted a secure Himalayan frontier after the Ring Fence / Subsidiary phase.

Course of the war, 1814–16

- Early British campaigns struggled in the hills against Gurkha defence.
- **Nalapani** is remembered for **Balbhadra Kunwar's** defence.
- **David Ochterlony** pressed **Amar Singh Thapa** and turned the war toward a British settlement.

Results — Treaty of Sugauli, 1816

- Nepal ceded **Kumaon** and **Garhwal** (गढ़वाल).
- It also ceded **Sikkim west of the Kali (काली)** and strips of the **Tarai**.
- Nepal remained **independent**. It was **not annexed**.
- A British Resident sat at Kathmandu.
- The British gained hill tracts later associated with **Shimla, Ranikhet and Nainital (नैनीताल)**.

- **Kathmandu was not obtained.**
- Gurkha recruitment into the British army began after the war.

> **Logic:** Kathmandu trap is standard. Sugauli ≠ Lahore.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q114

Which of the following sites were obtained by the British East India Company under the Treaty of Sugauli in 1816?

1. Kathmandu
2. Shimla
3. Ranikhet
4. Nainital

A. 1 and 2

B. Only 3 and 4

C. 2, 3 and 4

D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: C — Hills from ceded tracts; **Kathmandu stayed Nepalese**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q137

Consider the following events and arrange them in chronological order starting from the earliest:

1. Vellore Mutiny
2. Death of Nana Fadnavis
3. Recall of Wellesley
4. Anglo-Nepalese War

A. 2, 3, 1, 4

B. 4, 1, 3, 2

C. 2, 3, 4, 1

D. 3, 1, 2, 4

Show answer

Ans: A — Nana Fadnavis d. **1800** → Wellesley recalled **1805** → Vellore **1806** → Anglo-Nepal **1814–16**.

2.14 Anglo-Burmese Wars

First Anglo-Burmese War, 1824–26

Causes

- Border clashes in Assam / Arakan and Burmese expansion under the Konbaung kings.
- GG = **Amherst**, not Dalhousie.

Course

- Hard jungle and river campaign drained both sides.
- **Maha Bandula** was killed at Danubyu in **1825**.
- British pressure finally forced Ava to treat.

Results

- The **Treaty of Yandabo, 1826** gave the Company **Assam, Manipur, Arakan and Tenasserim**.
- War cost was heavy, but Assam entered British orbit.

Second Anglo-Burmese War, 1852

Causes

- Trade and insult disputes under Dalhousie's forward annexation mood.
- Lower Burma commerce and Rangoon control mattered more than Ava's inland court.

Course

- Short coastal–Irrawaddy campaign against a weaker Ava court.

Results

- **Pegu / Lower Burma** was annexed. Upper Burma still remained under the Konbaung king for a time.

Third Anglo-Burmese War, 1885

Causes

- **Thibaw's** court politics and British commercial fear of **French** influence in Upper Burma.

Course

- Rapid advance on **Mandalay**. Little prolonged field war.

Results

- Thibaw was deposed. Upper Burma was taken. Burma became a province of British India.

> **Logic:** First Burma War is **not** Dalhousie's. Basic date fact = **Yandabo 1826**.

2.15 Sindh Annexation, 1843

Rulers: Talpur Amirs | GG **Ellenborough** | Field commander **Sir Charles Napier**

Causes

- After the **First Afghan War** the British wanted a secure **Indus** (सिंधु) supply route.
- Earlier pressure included commercial treaties and navigation rights on the Indus.
- **Ellenborough** chose conquest politics. **Napier** executed them in the field.
- The Talpur Amirs of Sindh were pressed beyond the older friendship treaties.

Course of the war

- Conquest was prepared gradually, then decided in the field in **1843**.
- **Battle of Miani (17 February 1843)** broke the main Amirs' army.
- **Battle of Dabo / Hyderabad (24 March 1843)** finished resistance.

Results

- Sindh was annexed in **1843** under Ellenborough / Napier — **not** under Dalhousie.
- Napier's reported telegram **"Peccavi"** ("I have sinned") is folklore, not a treaty name.
- Sindh became a British province / strategic Indus base before Punjab's fall in **1849**.

> **Logic:** Sindh is **1843**. Punjab is **1849**. Ellenborough / Napier, not Dalhousie.

2.16 Pindari campaign and Vellore Mutiny

Pindaris (Lord Hastings)

Causes

- Pindari plunder bands in Malwa / Central India raided Company and allied lands.
- Early nineteenth-century leaders often keyed are **Chittu**, **Karim Khan** and **Basil Mohammad**.
- Lord Hastings linked the Pindari hunt with the final smash of Maratha independence.

Course

- The **Pindari campaign (1817–18)** ran alongside the **Third Anglo-Maratha War**.
- British columns from Bengal, the Deccan and Gujarat closed a ring on Malwa.
- Pindari bands were chased, broken and denied sanctuary with Maratha houses.

Results

- Pindari power was destroyed.
- With the Peshwa's fall, British paramountcy in central India was complete.

Vellore Mutiny, 1806

Causes

- New dress codes, leather cockades and caste-religious regulations angered Madras sepoys.
- Tipu's sons and family were confined in **Vellore** fort after **1799**, which kept Mysore memory alive in the garrison town.
- The rising sits after Wellesley's recall (**1805**).

Course

- On **10 July 1806** sepoys rose in the fort at **Vellore**.
- Officers were killed and the Tipu standard was briefly raised.
- Colonel Gillespie's relief from Arcot crushed the mutiny the same day.

Results

- The mutiny was crushed. Dress orders were rolled back in part.
- It is an expansion-era chronology fact (after Wellesley **1805**, before Nepal **1814**), not the Revolt of **1857**.

> **Logic:** Nana Fadnavis d. **1800** → Wellesley recalled **1805** → Vellore **1806** → Anglo-Nepal **1814–16**.

2.17 Neighbouring frontiers — Afghan, Bhutan, Tibet, NW policy

First Anglo-Afghan War, 1839–42

Causes

- Nineteenth-century Anglo-Afghan policy rested on fear of **Russian** expansion toward India (British memory often tags the Russo–Iranian **Treaty of Turkmenchay, 1828**).
- **Auckland** planned to replace **Dost Muhammad** with **Shah Shuja**.

Course

- British entered Kabul, then faced rising resistance.
- The **1842 retreat from Kabul** was a disaster. Elphinstone's column was destroyed.

Results

- Company failure. Dost Muhammad returned.
- The disaster fed later **Masterly Inactivity** under John Lawrence.

Second Anglo-Afghan War, 1878–80

Causes

- **Lytton's Proud Reserve** was the **Forward Policy** line on Afghanistan in the 1870s.
- Embassy disputes and fear of Russian influence opened war.

Course

- British invasions and fluctuating Kabul politics followed.
- The **Treaty of Gandamak** phase tried to bind Afghan foreign policy.

Results

- Temporary British control of Afghan foreign policy.
- Later **Abdur Rahman** settled as Amir under British influence on external affairs.

Third Anglo-Afghan War, 1919

Causes

- Afghan bid for full independence after World War I.

Course

- Short frontier war.

Results

- Afghanistan gained independence in foreign affairs.

Masterly Inactivity vs Proud Reserve / Forward Policy

- **John Lawrence's Masterly Inactivity** meant caution on Afghanistan after the First War — watch the frontier, avoid costly occupation.
- **Lytton's Proud Reserve** was the named **Forward Policy** of the 1870s — assert influence inside Afghan politics rather than wait.
- Do not swap the two. Masterly Inactivity is Lawrence's brake. Forward Policy / Proud Reserve is Lytton's accelerator.

Anglo-Bhutanese War → Treaty of Sinchula, 1865

Causes

- Border friction in Assam / Duars.

Course

- British campaign in the Duars in the 1860s.

Results

- The **Treaty of Sinchula (1865)** gave Britain the **Duars**.
- Bhutan kept independence with a subsidy arrangement.

Younghusband mission to Tibet, 1904

Causes

- Curzon's frontier anxiety about Russian influence in Tibet.

Course

- Armed British mission under **Younghusband** reached Lhasa.

Results

- Treaty pressure on Tibet. Tibet was **not** annexed as a British province.

> **Logic:** Do not place First Afghan War under Dalhousie. Masterly Inactivity ≠ Proud Reserve.

2.18 Banaras Rebellion and Akbar Fort, Prayagraj

Banaras Rebellion / Chait Singh, 1781

UP event | present-day **Varanasi** (वाराणसी) | Raja **Chait Singh** vs **Warren Hastings** | **August–October 1781**

Banaras (Benares) was a semi-autonomous zamindari under Company overlordship after the mid-18th century settlements with Awadh. Raja **Balwant Singh** had earlier secured recognition (मान्यता); his successor **Chait Singh** held Banaras when Hastings pressed for war money.

Causes

- Hastings needed cash and troops for Company wars against the **Marathas**, **Mysore**, and European rivals.
- From **1778** he levied an emergency war subsidy on Chait Singh (often cited as about **₹5 lakh**, repeated in later years). Coaching notes also use a larger arrears / penalty figure of about **₹23 lakh** for the final confrontation.
- Hastings also demanded about **2,000 cavalry** for Company use. Chait Singh delayed or refused full compliance.
- Hastings treated this as disobedience and went personally to Banaras in **August 1781** to enforce payment and punish the Raja.

Course

- At **Shivala (Sivala)** in Banaras, Hastings tried to place Chait Singh under arrest / house arrest.
- Chait Singh's supporters rose, attacked the small Company guard, and killed officers and sepoys. This is sometimes called the **Shivala / Sivala** clash.
- Hastings barely escaped and took shelter at **Chunar Fort**.
- The rising spread into nearby countryside and briefly disturbed Company lines toward Awadh / Bihar posts.
- Company columns, including forces under **Major Popham**, crushed the revolt by about **October 1781**.
- Chait Singh fled toward **Gwalior** / Bundelkhand exile. He was deposed.

Results

- Banaras came under much closer Company control. A more pliant relative, **Mahip Narayan Singh**, was installed as Raja with reduced real power.
- Annual tribute and Company supervision tightened. Banaras's earlier virtual autonomy ended.
- The Banaras episode, along with the **Begums of Awadh** case and Rohilla charges, became a main count in Hastings's long **impeachment (1788–95)** in Britain. He was finally **acquitted**.
- This is a **1781 Warren Hastings** event in UP. It is **not** the 1857 Banaras rising and not a Dalhousie annexation.

Lock	Fact
Year	**1781**
Place	**Banaras / Varanasi** (Shivala; Hastings fled to **Chunar**)
Raja	**Chait Singh**
Company head	**Warren Hastings**
Suppression	**Major Popham** and reinforcing columns
Aftermath	Deposition; closer Company control; impeachment charge

Akbar Fort, Prayagraj

- This is the Mughal fort at the **Ganga (गंगा)–Yamuna (यमुना) sangam (संगम)** at Allahabad / Prayagraj.
- It is **not** the Delhi or Agra fort (आगरा किला).
- The **Treaty of Allahabad, 1765** was settled in this belt.
- **Shah Alam II** lived for a time under Company protection here.
- The Company also tightened control of the Doab.

UP Focus

Site	Expansion fact
Prayagraj / Allahabad	1765 treaty; Akbar Fort; fort handed over by **Saadat Ali Khan II** in **1798**
Awadh	Shuja at Buxar; Begums case linked to Hastings's impeachment; subsidiary 1801; annex 1856
Banaras / Varanasi	**Chait Singh rebellion 1781** vs Warren Hastings; Shivala clash; Chunar refuge
Chunar	Hastings sheltered here during the 1781 rising
Sardhana (Meerut (मेरठ))	**Begum Samru** church; Sardhana jagir after Walter Reinhardt Sombre
Jhansi	Lapse 1853 → later 1857 revolt
Rohilkhand	Rohilla War 1774; later Awadh cessions

> **Logic:** Banaras **1781** = **Warren Hastings** vs **Chait Singh**. Do not merge with 1857. Akbar Fort = **Prayagraj** (प्रयागराज). Prayagraj fort transfer = **1798**, not 1790–97.
